

Around 25 years ago, little did anyone know that the World Wide Web would take over the globe and transform the way we conduct businesses and even interact with each other on a day-to-day basis. There was virtually no means of online shopping or entertainment or any business done online. All of that has changed over the last two to three decades. Almost every aspect of our lives has been taken over by the internet. This large scale adoption of the World Wide Web as we know it today didn't happen overnight. In its initial stages, the internet and its supporting technologies were met with uncertainty and its share of criticisms.

While the internet did see a phase of people welcoming it with open arms, blockchain technology may or may not see the same level of acceptance. One of the main reasons is that even if its adopted, most of the work done by this technology will be behind the scenes. For it to enter the mainstream and to see everyday people using blockchain is not going to be an easy task, largely given how complex a network it is. Bitcoin, the most popular of blockchain-based applications, is challenging how people view the idea of blockchain. However, adoption in everyday lives is far from being around the corner.

But think of larger governing bodies and institutions like healthcare, insurance, or even governments that are buried under piles of paperwork. There is real potential for blockchain to be put to optimum use here. The benefits of blockchain can be circled down to three main aspects — speed, efficiency and security. Think of these benefits from the perspective of the public sectors organisation and you will see why the marriage between governing bodies and blockchain technology could be a blessing in disguise for agency officials and citizens alike.

Around three years ago none of the government agencies across the world were even considering the use of blockchain. Today several countries including our own are running pilot tests in various states to verify the application of blockchain in the public sector. These tests are being run at two levels -

- 1) Broader architectural tests to determine if blockchain can offer better functionality on the broader spectrum of everyday governance
- 2) Internal communication between various agencies of the public sector or even internally between various levels of the same agency

Let's look at some examples of countries that have already adopted blockchain or are looking forward to in the foreseeable future.